*The 2025*

# On-Target Report

Advanced audience insights to fuel your marketing strategy

Nielsen

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# Introduction

Media is changing. Is your marketing still on target?

To say that media is changing is, of course, a massive understatement. From production to programming, distribution and viewing habits, the transformation over the past few years has been radical. Television as a whole today is a growing and rapidly evolving medium with boundless creative energy and a seemingly infinite content catalog.

More content means new opportunities to connect with specific audiences—provided brands can find their target customers. The proliferation of screens, platforms and advertising formats today means understanding what audiences are watching—and where and how they're watching—is both more critical and more complex than just targeting popular content with generic ad buys.

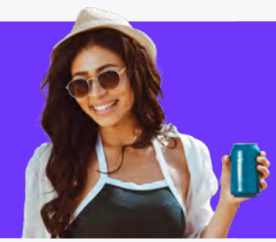
As media changes, so too are marketing strategies. Brands have more tools in their toolbelt than ever—from traditional advertising to brand sponsorships, product placements, celebrity endorsements, influencer partnerships and more. Yet the starting point remains the same: a clear understanding of your target audience and how they're consuming media.

At Nielsen, we understand viewers, and we measure television in all its forms. We're uniquely positioned to help brands understand where their target audiences are spending their time, beyond traditional age and gender groups to more advanced audience profiles, and we can show you how to use those insights to optimize your total marketing strategy.

This report is a short introduction to those capabilities through a few select advanced audiences:

**New Moms**
Women between the ages of 18 and 44 with a child under 2

**Electric Vehicle Curious**
People 18+ interested in an electric vehicle (EV) for their next car



**Soda Drinkers**
People 18+ who purchased soft drinks over the past 12 months

Many of the insights in this report are inclusive of all viewing, not just ad-supported viewing. As advertisers look to understand the landscape of these advanced audiences, further analyses can help refine these insights specifically to the ad-supported business.

We hope you find the insights and guidance in this report valuable. If you'd like to learn more about how you can leverage additional analyses of these segments and others, please visit nielsen.com or contact a Nielsen representative.

Section

# 1

# New Moms



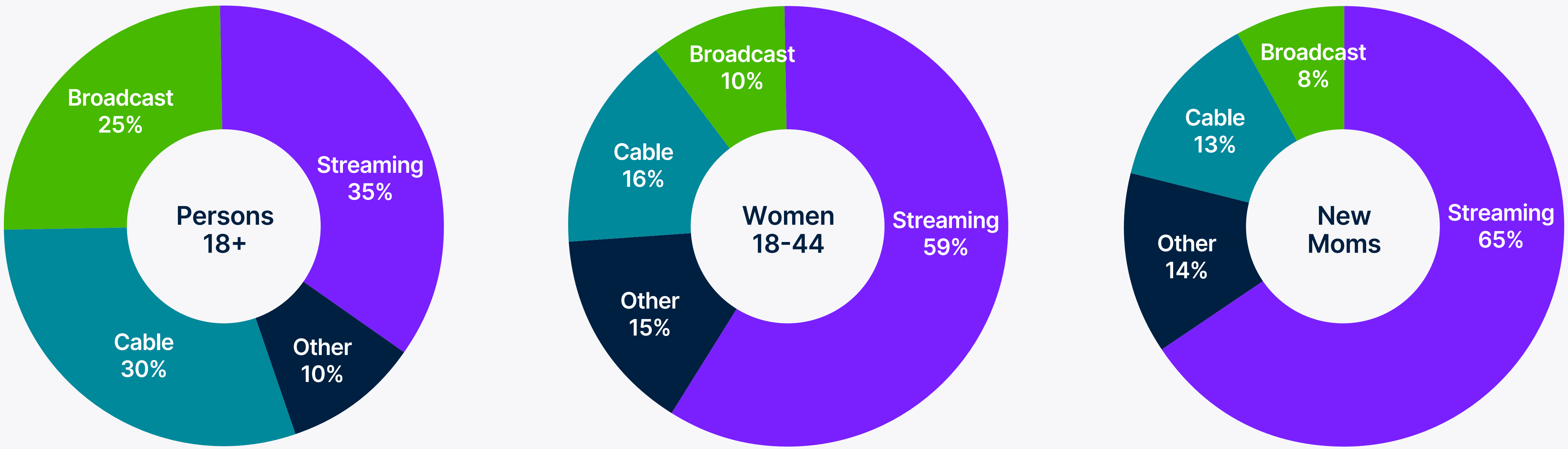
# How New Moms watch TV

The first audience we looked at was New Moms: women 18-44 with a child under 2. Representing just under 4% of the total population 18 and older in the U.S., these consumers often have unique spending (and media) habits with young children in the home.

In the first quarter of 2024, New Moms devoted significantly more of their total TV time to streaming than all people 18 and older in the U.S. These habits reflect those of their larger segment (all women 18-44 in the U.S.); however, New Moms comparatively still spend a larger share of their time with streaming.

Figure 1.1

## New Moms' TV time




Advanced Audience: The New Moms (women 18-44 with a child under 2)
Source: Nielsen National TV Ratings plus Streaming Platform Ratings, Q1 2024
Note: "Other" includes all other TV usage that does not fall into the broadcast, cable or streaming categories; streaming of broadcast or cable content contributes to those categories, and is removed from streaming. Also, data represents all viewing including ad-supported and non-ad supported.

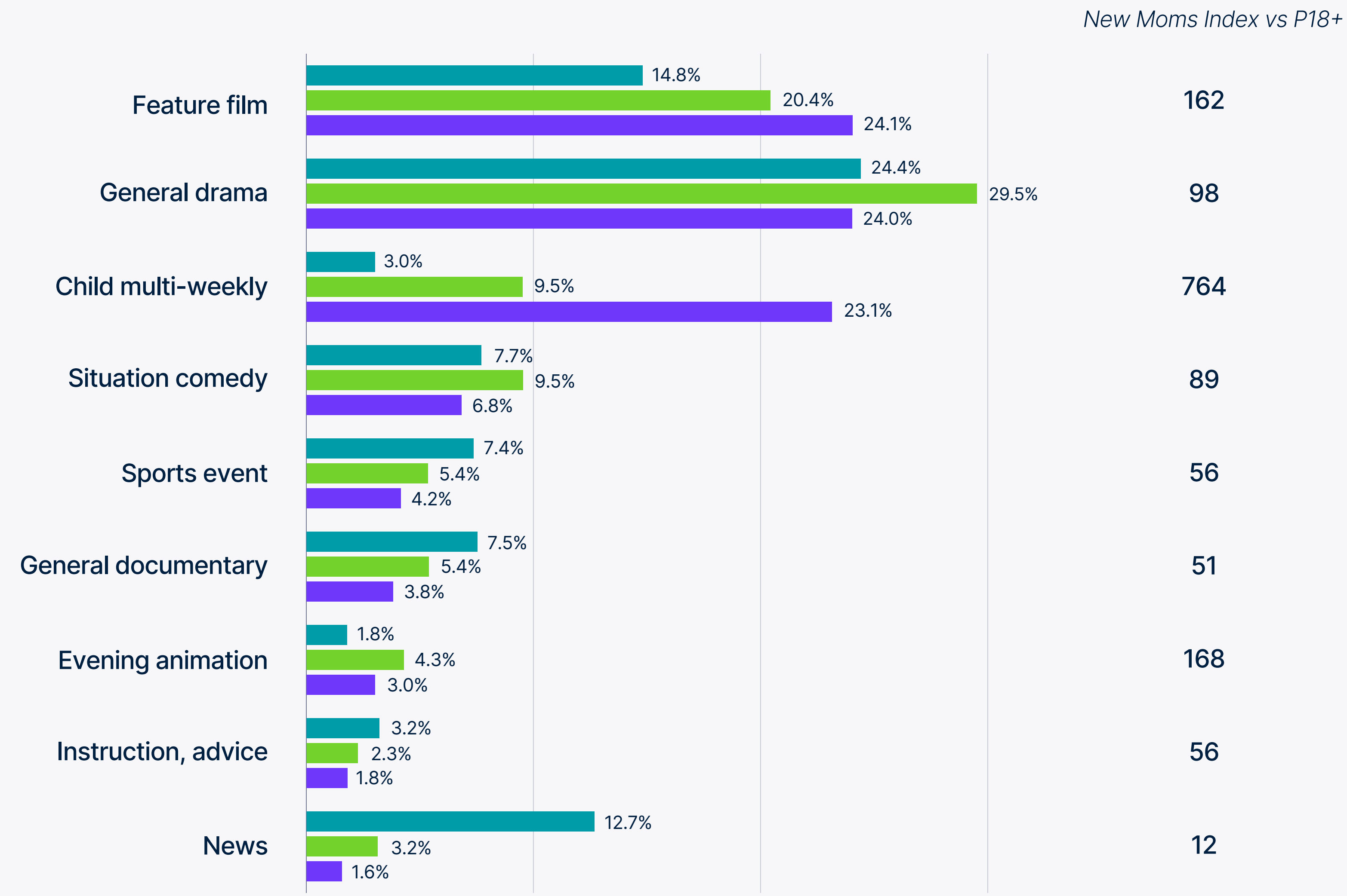
# How New Moms' TV viewing varies by genre

It's hardly surprising that New Moms spend so much time streaming considering how much on-demand of young children's programming can be found on these services. And it makes perfect sense that New Moms are spending a lot more of their TV time watching children programs and movies (many of them likely to be kids movies) than the rest of the population. Of course, that also means that they have less time for everything else.

Figure 1.1

## Comparing New Moms' viewership by genre

P18+
Women 18-44
New Moms




Advanced Audience: The New Moms (women 18-44 with a child under 2)
Source: Nielsen National TV Ratings plus Streaming Content Ratings. Based on Share of Gross Minutes. Q1 2024

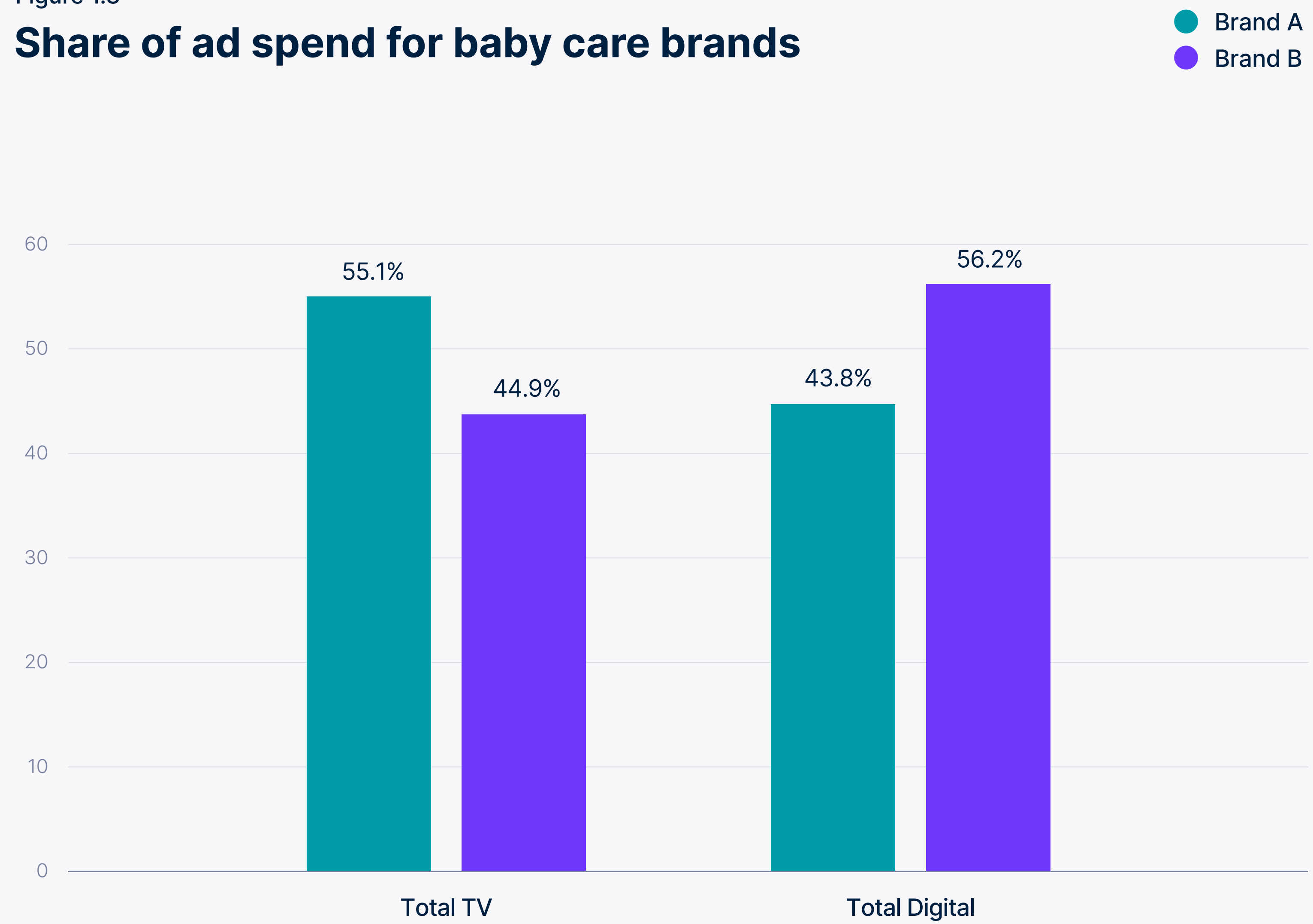
# Spotlight: How baby care brands are spending

While New Moms spend a significant portion of their media time on streaming platforms, not all brands are leaning into digital and connected TV (CTV) advertising, as we can see from the budget allocations of two of the largest baby care brands on the market today. One of the reasons is that ad inventory is still very limited across most streaming platforms, but brand sponsorships or partnerships with celebrities from these platforms could help marketers create connections with this audience.

With New Moms, brands also need to consider who is actively watching programs. Given the popularity of feature films and children's programs, these audiences are likely co-viewing with their kids. Additional analyses of this segment that we can offer at the program level could help brands unlock opportunities to better connect with New Moms—after their kids have gone to bed.

Figure 1.3

## Share of ad spend for baby care brands




Note: Total TV includes network, cable and spot TV, including spanish-language as applicable; total digital includes CTV, digital display, digital social, digital video and national digital - search.
Source: Nielsen Ad Intel, Q1 2024

Section

# 2

# The Electric Vehicle Curious

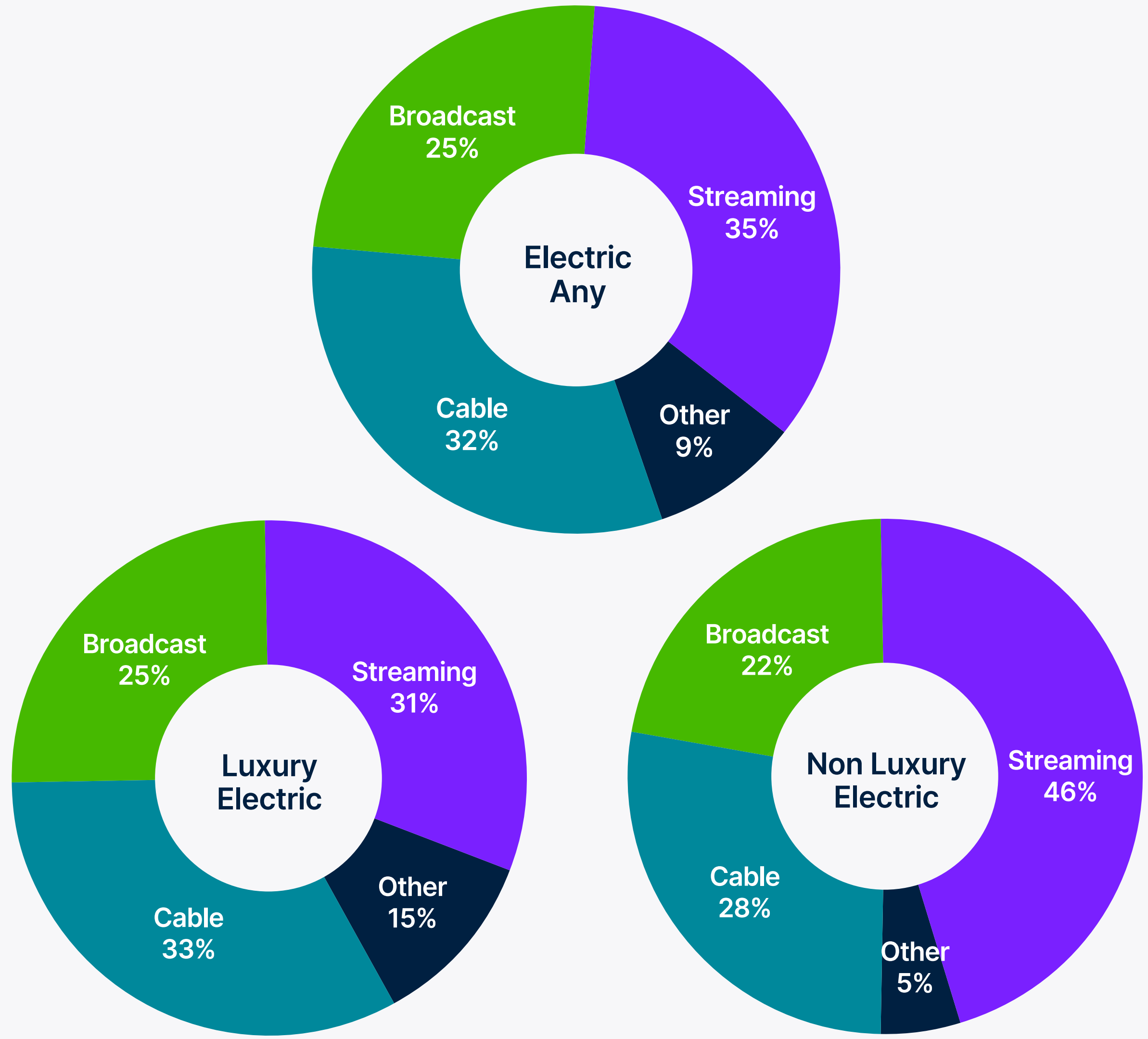
# How the EV Curious watch TV

The rise of electric vehicles (EVs) over the last few years has shaken up the auto industry. Consumer expectations are shifting as new competitors have entered the space, introducing new features, direct purchasing and online ordering. On top of that, the auto industry contends with long consumer journeys, with owners waiting an average of two to five years to replace their vehicles. So while people 18 and older in the U.S. who are interested in an EV for their next car currently represent just over 1% of the population, brands need to understand this advanced audience and how they consume media in order to foster a long-term connection for the future.

In the first quarter of 2024, the EV Curious' time with TV closely matched people 18 and older in the U.S. However, there's a big difference in how EV Curious consumers spend their time on TV, **depending on whether they're interested in luxury or non-luxury EV brands.**

Figure 2.1

## The EV Curious' TV Time




Advanced Audience: EV Curious (interested in EV for their next car)
Source: Nielsen National TV Ratings augmented by Streaming Platform Ratings and Polk data, Q1 2024
Note: "Other" includes all other TV usage that does not fall into the broadcast, cable or streaming categories; streaming of broadcast or cable content contributes to those categories, and is removed from streaming.
Also, data represents all viewing including ad-supported and non-ad supported.

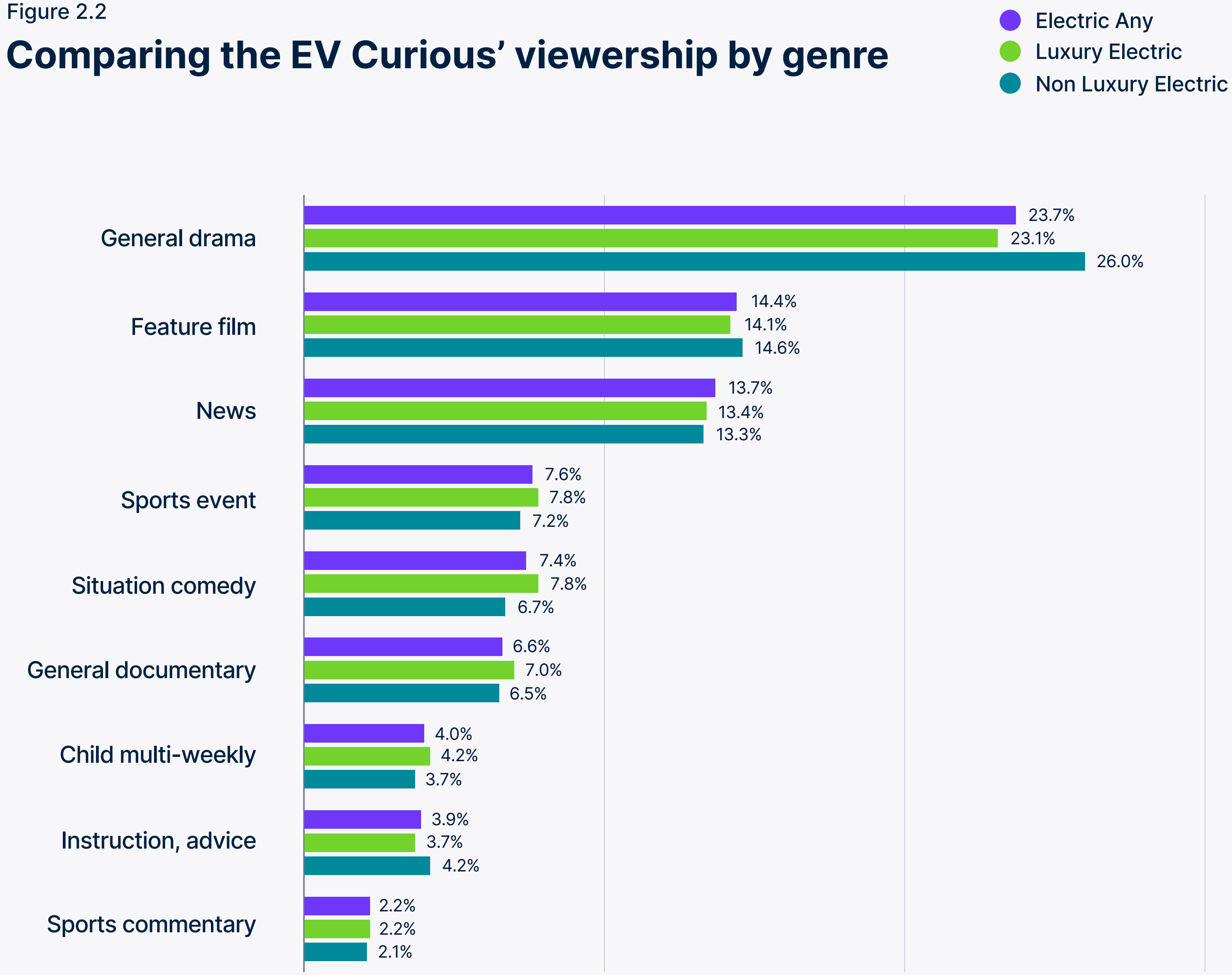
# How the EV Curious' TV viewing varies by genre

Those who are curious about non-luxury EV brands spend less time on linear TV and a lot more on streaming platforms, while those curious about luxury EV brands spend a bigger share on cable. And these trends can also be seen at the genre level.

Consumers interested in non-luxury EV spent more of their TV time watching dramas and feature films—prominent content from key streaming providers—than those interested in luxury brands, and slightly less watching sports, sitcoms and documentaries.

Figure 2.2

## Comparing the EV Curious' viewership by genre




Advanced Audience: EV Curious (interested in EV for their next car)
Source: Nielsen National TV Ratings augmented by Streaming Platform Ratings and Polk data, Q1 2024

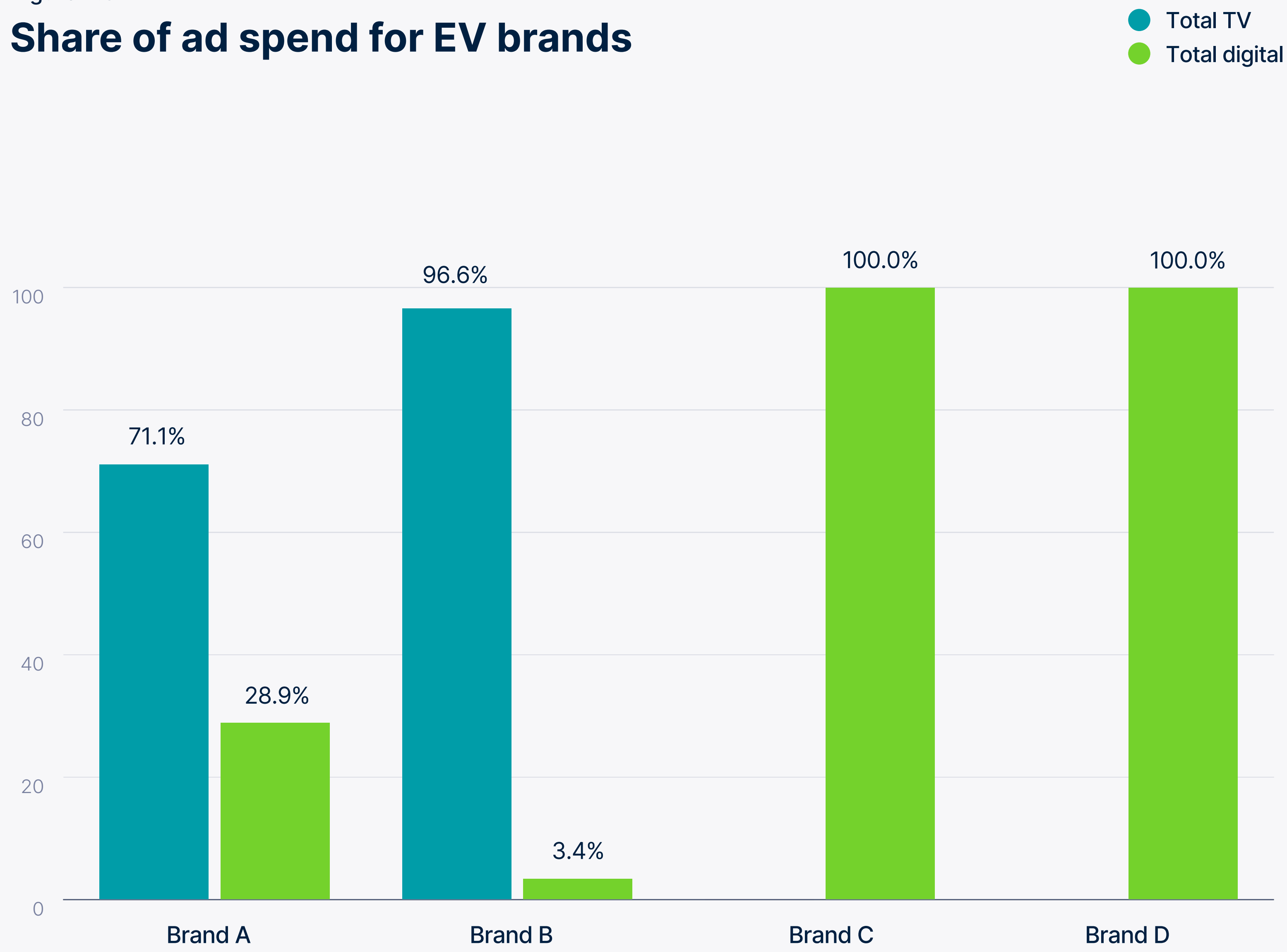
# Spotlight: How EV brands are spending

We examined how four EV brands (a mix of luxury and non-luxury) balanced their media budgets in the first quarter of 2024 and found a wide disparity in media mixes. Some are spending a much larger share of their ad dollars on traditional media, while others are almost exclusively investing in digital advertising.

To reach EV Curious consumers, brands should consider a more nuanced cross-media approach and spread their spend across both traditional and digital channels. While digital channels can offer lower costs and effective targeting, advanced audience insights can help target the EV Curious across traditional channels as well—particularly for reaching those interested in luxury vehicles.

Figure 2.3

## Share of ad spend for EV brands




Note: Total TV includes network, cable and spot TV, including spanish-language as applicable; total digital includes CTV, digital display, digital social, digital video and national digital - search.
Source: Nielsen Ad Intel, Q1 2024

Section

# 3

# Soda Drinkers

# How Soda Drinkers watch TV

Whether you call it "soda," "pop" or something else, soft drinks have long been a beloved beverage. By far, Soda Drinkers represent the largest advanced audience we looked at in this study: 54% of people 18 and older in the U.S. have purchased soft drinks over the past 12 months.

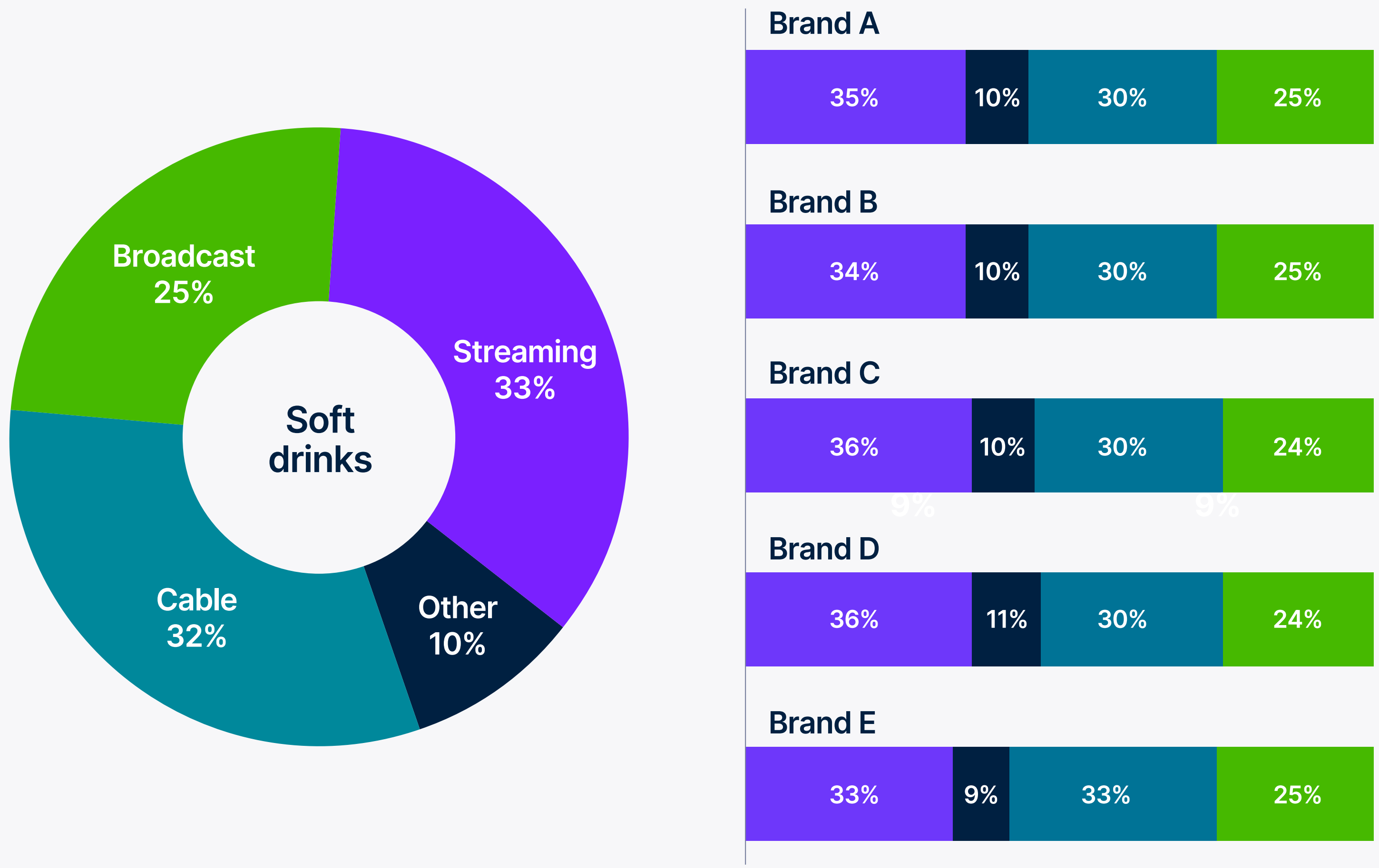
Despite this popularity, however, the soft drinks category has struggled over the last few years. A trend toward healthier options has affected the larger beverage category, and inflation has created pricing pressures across the entire consumer packaged goods (CPG) industry.

For soft drink brands, understanding how shoppers spend time across the total television landscape can unlock key advanced audience insights. In the first quarter of 2024, Soda Drinkers watched TV across platforms very much like other people 18 and older in the U.S.—not surprising given that the group represents more than half of the total population.

Even when we examine how consumers of five specific soda brands split their time between broadcast, cable and streaming, the variations from brand to brand were very minimal. We need to dig deeper to find meaningful differences.

Figure 3.1

## Soda Drinkers' TV Time



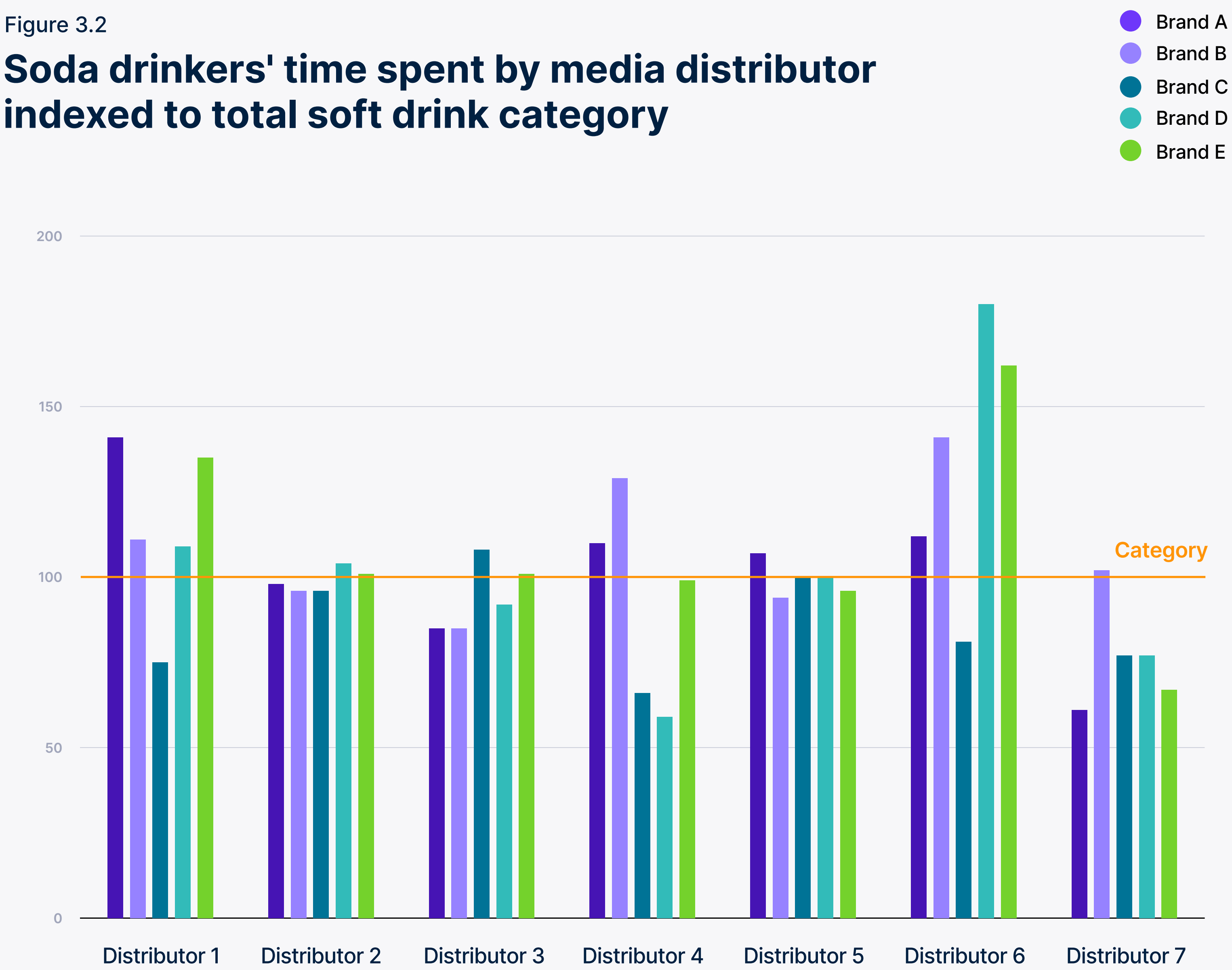

Advanced Audience: Soda Drinkers (purchased soft drinks over the past 12 months)
Source: Nielsen National TV Ratings augmented by Streaming Platform Ratings and NCSolutions, Q1 2024
Note: "Other" includes all other TV usage that does not fall into the broadcast, cable or streaming categories; streaming of broadcast or cable content contributes to those categories, and is removed from streaming. Also, data represents all viewing including ad-supported and non-ad supported.

# How Soda Drinkers' TV habits vary across distributors

To find meaningful differences at the brand level, we looked at time spent at the media distributor level. Taking the top seven distributors for the category as a whole indexed to the total population, there is significant variation by brand. For example, shoppers of A, D and E over index for several distributors compared to the category as a whole, whereas shoppers of brand C under index for several distributors.

Figure 3.2

## Soda drinkers' time spent by media distributor indexed to total soft drink category




Advanced Audience: Soda Drinkers (purchased soft drinks over the past 12 months)
Source: Nielsen National TV Ratings augmented by Streaming Platform Ratings and NCSolutions, Q1 2024
Note: "Other" includes all other TV usage that does not fall into the broadcast, cable or streaming categories; streaming of linear content has been removed from streaming (but does count toward broadcast and cable).

# Spotlight: How soda brands are spending

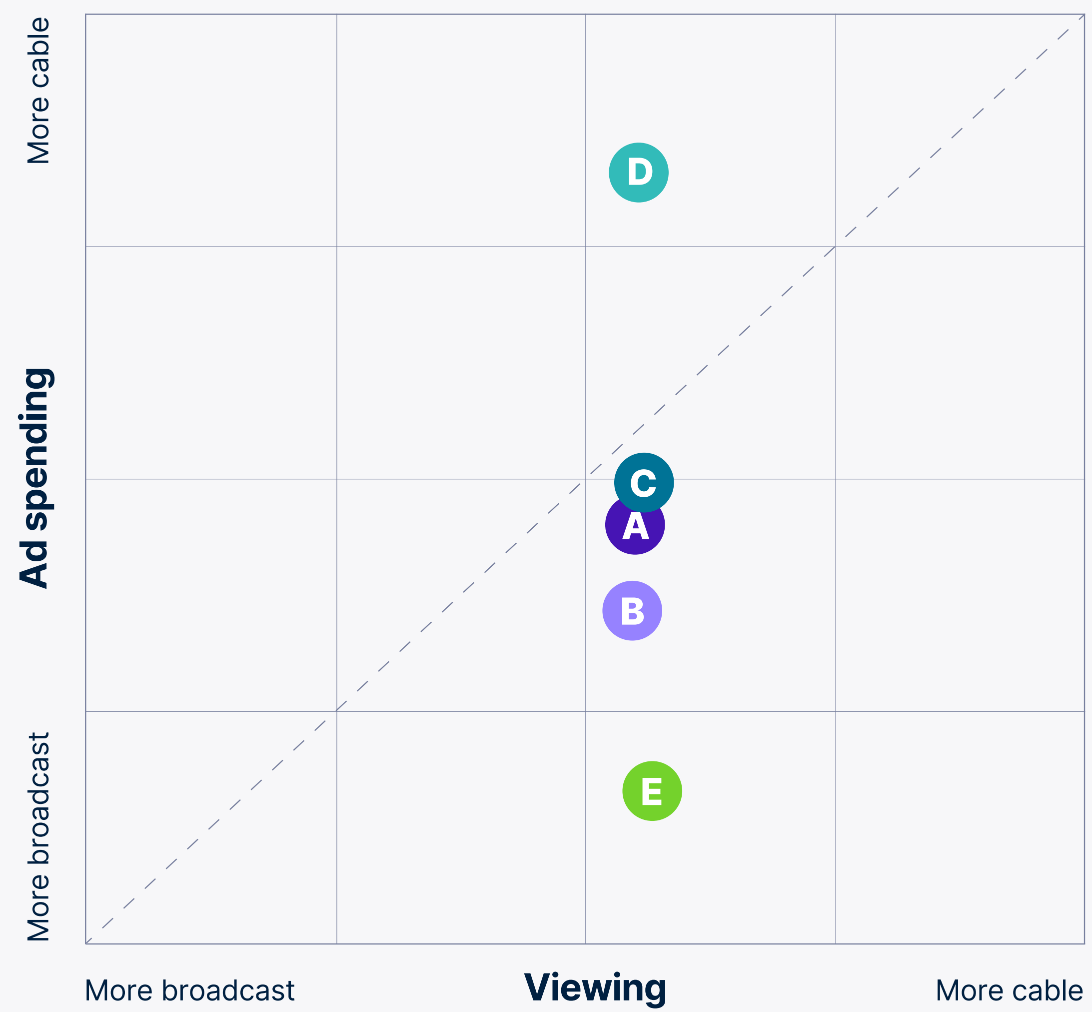
This plot shows where consumers of brands A through E were splitting their time between broadcast and cable TV in Q1 2024, and how each brand at the time was allocating its linear TV budget. Some brands (like A and C) had well-balanced media allocations between broadcast and cable, but others clearly invested disproportionately in broadcast (B and E) or cable (D).

Advanced audience insights can help brands better understand where their audiences are watching. And by combining these insights with competitive ad intelligence, brands can spot gaps in their competitors' media strategy and unlock new opportunities to engage consumers.

Figure 3.3

## Share of ad spend for soft drink brands

*Are soft drink brands advertising where their consumers are?*




Note: Cable and Network TV include spanish-language as applicable.
Source: Nielsen Ad Intel, Q1 2024

# Key takeaways

The analyses we shared above are good examples of the value of advanced audiences and the types of insights brands can expect to uncover with access to reliable competitive media intelligence and cross-channel audience data. We've only scratched the surface in this report—viewing patterns can be explored for additional advanced audiences down to the individual program—but we can already point to a number of important takeaways for advertisers:

### TV is now a fractured multi-platform experience—Embrace it

Viewers are clearly spreading their time across many different TV platforms these days. Thankfully, reliable cross-media data is finally available to make sense of it all: comprehensive, deduplicated and directly comparable.

### Move past age and gender to unleash your target audiences

While traditional demos remain useful benchmarks for planning purposes, you can target very specific audiences today on dozens of modern TV platforms. Seize that opportunity to get closer to your target audiences.

### Your marketing mix needs to evolve with the times

You need enough flexibility in your creative and budget process to rebalance your total marketing spend to reflect the viewing patterns of your target audiences. Think beyond the generic ad buy to reach audiences wherever they're watching.

### Competitive media intelligence is more critical than ever

In today's ultra-competitive markets, you need to know where your competitors are spending their respective budgets, and why. They might know something you don't know, or they might be making a mistake you could exploit. Make sure you pay attention.

### Be ready to challenge historical assumptions

Media planning is both an art and a science, but too many brands still lean heavily into the 'art' side of the equation and recycle the same old plans. With reliable cross-media data, you can feel confident that new approaches will deliver predictable results.

## Ready to get answers?

For a more complete report and a deeper dive into the value of cross-media measurement and advanced audiences for your business, please visit nielsen.com or contact your Nielsen representative.

For more details on Advanced Audiences and Nielsen ONE, the industry's most complete and reliable cross-media data, click here.

# Methodology

The data for this report was derived from two separately weighted panels and combined to determine share of total TV viewing. Nielsen's streaming data is derived from a subset of Streaming Meter-enabled TV households within the National TV panel. The linear TV sources (broadcast and cable), as well as total usage are based on viewing from Nielsen's overall TV panel.

All the data is time period based for each viewing source. The data, representing a broadcast quarter, is based on Live+7 viewing for the reporting interval (Note: Live+7 includes live television viewing plus viewing up to seven days later for linear content).

The "other" includes all other TV usage that does not fall into the broadcast, cable or streaming categories. This primarily includes all other tuning (unmeasured sources), unmeasured video on demand (VOD), audio streaming, gaming and other device (DVD playback) use.

Linear streaming (as defined by the aggregation of viewing to vMVPD/MVPD apps) was excluded from the streaming category as the broadcast and cable content viewed through these apps was credited to its respective category. Linear streaming via vMVPD apps (e.g., Hulu Live, YouTube TV) were excluded from the streaming category.

### Television methodology

Television data is derived from Nielsen's National TV Panel that is based on a sample of over 41,000 homes and 101,000 real people that are selected based on area probability sampling.

### Streaming Content Ratings

Audience measurement data that details how consumers are spending time with programs and episodes viewed through the top streaming platforms.

### Streaming Platform Ratings

Audience measurement data that details the amount of time consumers spend streaming and on which platforms.

### Nielsen Ad Intel

Ad Intel is the most complete source of cross-platform advertising intelligence available today. With intuitive software, review-and-compare ad activity across media, company, category or brand, plus historical data. Nielsen monitors gross advertising expenditure in major media at published rate card values.

# About Nielsen

Nielsen is a global leader in audience measurement, data and analytics. Through our understanding of people and their behaviors across all channels and platforms, we empower our clients with independent and actionable intelligence so they can connect and engage with their global audiences—now and into the future. Learn more at www.nielsen.com and connect with us on social media (X, LinkedIn, YouTube, Facebook and Instagram).